

Unit Y305: The Renaissance c.1400–c.1600

This theme focuses on the causes, nature and extent of Renaissance artistic, cultural and political developments throughout the course of the 15th and 16th centuries in both Italy and northern Europe. Learners should consider how far the Renaissance was a significant historical turning point leading to innovation and change or a gradual extension and continuation of the medieval world. Consideration should be given to the influence of Italy on developments elsewhere and the extent of similarities and differences between individual and regional

contributions across the period. Developments in the Italian states and northern Europe should be key areas of study, although reference might also be made to Hungary and Spain. The strands below are not to be studied in isolation to each other.

Learners are not expected to demonstrate a detailed understanding of the specification content, except for the named in-depth studies, but are expected to know the main developments and turning points relevant to the theme.

Thematic Study: The Renaissance c.1400–c.1600	
Key Topics	Content Learners should have studied the following:
Artistic and cultural development	The cultural conditions in western Europe c.1400; the origins and causes of the Renaissance, social, political, economic and cultural factors; the development of, and changes in, artistic and literary styles and techniques; regional variations in art (Flanders and the northern Renaissance, Venetian Renaissance, Christian humanism); the High Renaissance; the role of trade, wealth, guilds, the middle-class and civic and private patronage in artistic development; the impact of republicanism and the Italian communes; the influence of humanism, the classical past and the Greek East and the impact of the fall of Constantinople; the impact of Florence, Rome and Venice on artistic and cultural development; the influence of Neo-Platonism; printing, libraries, the role of education, schools and the ideal of the 'Renaissance man' in the development of the Renaissance; continuity with the Middle Ages.
The role of the individual	The contributions to the Renaissance of individual patrons, artists and scholars: including the early Medici (Cosimo and Lorenzo 'the Magnificent'), Federico de Montefeltro, Ludovico Sforza; Nicholas V, Julius II, Charles V, Francis I, Savonarola, Bruni, Ficino, Machiavelli, Castiglione, Erasmus, Brunelleschi, Donatello, Alberti, Botticelli, Michelangelo, Leonardo da Vinci, Raphaël, Bramante, Titian, Dürer, More, Colet.
Religion and religious change	The condition of the Church and religious institutions; the Council of Florence, Rome and the importance of the Papacy and international links; the Renaissance Papacy and its condition and attitude to the Renaissance; Christianity and the Renaissance, the attitude of the church to the Renaissance; anti-clericalism; clerical advocates of the new learning; the role of Papal patronage; the impact of the Renaissance on church music, including Palestrina and Monteverdi.

The Impact of War	The ideal of Renaissance Man and Federigo da Montefeltro, Duke of Urbino, soldier-scholar; the impact on the Renaissance ideal of the French invasion of 1494; Condottieri, mercenaries and mercenary armies, humanist criticism of mercenaries; developments in warfare; war and Machiavelli, the Prince and the idea of Christian morality; military architecture.
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Depth studies	Content Learner should be aware of debates surrounding the issues outlined for each in-depth topic:
The Venetian Renaissance	The condition of Venice in c.1400; the social, economic and political conditions that encouraged the development of the Renaissance; the impact of the Greek East and the fall of Constantinople; artistic development in Venice; the importance of printing and education; the impact of the Doge; the myth of Venice; the church in Venice and reform; the impact of war on Venice.
Savonarola	Savonarola as a preacher; prophesying; the impact of the French invasion and the fall of Piero de' Medici; Florence under Savonarola, political change, moral reform, the Bonfire of the Vanities; the fall of Savonarola; Savonarola's attitude to art and the Renaissance; the impact of his rule on art and artistic development.
The French Renaissance	Reasons for the development of the Renaissance in France; Renaissance monarchy in France under Louis XII, Francis I and Henry II; the monarchs as patrons of art, literature and architecture, including Chambord and Blois; the impact of da Vinci, del Sarto, Cellini, Rabelais; the impact of the Italian Wars.